FREDDIE PHILPOT

Additional Info

Email

contact@freddiephilpot.dev

Portfolio

freddiephilpot.dev

Personal Statement

I am a dedicated student with real-world expertise in networking, cloud-hosted infrastructure, and Linux systems. My exposure to SOC operations, digital forensics, and software development workflows during my placement at Tesco's Head Office strengthened my interest in large-scale systems and cyber security. By managing VPNs, DNS services, monitoring tools, and enterprise apps like Splunk in my home lab, I actively develop my skills. I'm preparing for a career in cyber security, cloud engineering, and security operations, and I intend to pursue Further maths, Maths, and Physics for my A-levels.

Skills

Technical Skills

- Linux administration and server management
- Networking fundamentals including DNS, VPNs, routing, and firewalls
- Cloud platforms and hosting (AWS, Azure, Oracle Cloud)
- Self-hosting and managing enterprise-grade applications (e.g. Splunk)
- Python scripting for automation and tooling
- Version control and workflow understanding (Git)

Personal Skills

- Problem-solving
- Teamwork and communication
- Organisation and reliability under pressure

Work Experience

Software Developer Student and Cyber Security Placement

Tesco Headquarters — Jul 2025 - Jul 2025

- Worked with the Software Development team to understand how large-scale systems are built, maintained, and deployed.
- Observed SOC operations, including incident triage, DFIR processes, and threat intelligence workflows.
- Gained experience with secure development practices and cross-team collaboration.
- Developed insight into the structure and responsibilities of enterprise cyber security functions.

Work Shadowing Student

Tesco Headquarters — Jul 2024 - Jul 2024

- Shadowed DevOps, automation, and IT support teams.
- Observed infrastructure management and automation workflows.
- Learned how technical incidents are handled and resolved.
- Gained early insight into corporate IT operations.

Library Volunteer - DofE

Hertfordshire Libraries — Jun 2024 - Sept 2024

- Assisted with the Summer Reading Challenge and supported participating families.
- Helped track progress, award certificates, and encourage engagement.
- Developed communication and customer-facing skills.

Projects

- Operate a home lab running Linux servers, VPNs, DNS, monitoring tools, and cloud-hosted services.
- Deploy and manage enterprise tools such as Splunk, Traefik, and self-hosted applications across on-prem and cloud.
- Configure secure networking using Pi-hole, dnsmasq, Tailscale, and custom reverse-proxy setups.
- Monitor system performance and security using Grafana, New Relic, and Zabbix, and manage device security through Jamf Now and Miradore.

Education

Monk's Walk School - GCSE Predicted Grades

Welwyn Garden City, Hertfordshire Sept 2020 - Present

8 – Computer Science, Mathematics, Physics, Chemistry, Biology
7 – Spanish
6 – English Language, English Literature, Art
Level 2 Distinction – Creative iMedia

Achievements

- Duke of Edinburgh Bronze Award (2025)
- Tesco Head Office Work Experience – invited back for a second week in Cyber Security
- ABRSM Grade 3 Piano – Merit
- Headteacher Awards (6 total) for effort, conduct, and contribution
- Subject Student of the Year – (KS4) Computer Science
  (KS3) Spanish and RE

Hobbies and Interests

I have a strong interest in technology and cybersecurity. I run a home lab where I manage Linux servers, VPNs, DNS services, monitoring tools, and cloud-hosted platforms. I enjoy learning about network security, ethical hacking, and enterprise-grade tools to deepen my technical understanding.

Outside technology, I enjoy golf, table tennis, and football with friends.

Referees

References available upon request